



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

I-League coronation will fuel Mohammedan Sporting's ISL journey

The club's return to the top division marks a **triumphant revival**, fuelled by a professional setup, strategic investment, and a commitment to nurturing local talent.

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Mohammedan Sporting has turned the arc-lights back on itself with the recent I-League triumph.

This reinstated the credence to its erstwhile stature as a football giant jostling for space alongside its city cousins — Mohun Bagan and East Bengal.

Much like a fallen hero in the historic context, Mohammedan Sporting's existence as a football club in the last few decades has been a

tale of pitiful decline. With controversies and mediocrity engulfing it, the once towering force in Indian football was virtually relegated to oblivion.

As the first Indian team to win the prestigious Calcutta Football League in the pre-Independence period (in 1934), **Sporting assumed a stature that would dwarf the achievements of its more famous compatriots (Mohun Bagan and East Bengal).** It won the prestigious Calcutta Football League (CFL) five successive times from 1934 to 1938.

Despite being a couple of years younger than Mohun Bagan (Asia's

All smiles: Mirjalol Kosimov of Mohammedan Sporting celebrates after the win. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

oldest footballing institution), Mohammedan Sporting (established in 1891) straddled the sport like a colossus with a trove of trophies.

The club has recorded a lot of firsts in its list of achievements, besides winning the CFL. This includes feats like being the first Indian team to win an overseas tournament and the first Indian team to win the Durand Cup and the Rovers Cup without conceding a goal.